RDS supports read replication between regions for Aurora, MariaDB, MySQL, Oracle, and PostgreSQL databases. You can replicate your data from the data centers in North Virginia to the data centers in Ireland, for example. Three major use cases for this feature follow:

- Backing up data to another region for the unlikely event of an outage covering a complete region
- Transferring data to another region to be able to answer read requests with lower latency
- Migrating a database to another region

Creating read replication between two regions incurs an additional cost because you have to pay for the transferred data.

Promoting a read replica to a standalone database

Imagine your WordPress site became really popular. On the one hand, that's a great success. On the other hand, you are struggling with handling all that load with your cloud infrastructure. You are thinking about adding read replicas to your database to decrease the load on the primary database.

If you create a read-replication database to migrate a database from one region to another, or if you have to perform heavy and load-intensive tasks on your database, such as adding an index, it's helpful to switch your workload from the primary database to a read-replication database. The read replica must become the new primary database.

The following command promotes the read-replica database you created in this section to a standalone primary database. Note that